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Quality Handoff Guide

Use this guide when you need to describe **measures, targets, security, compliance, resilience, observability, or important quality findings**.

This guide is about **how good is good enough**, **how it is measured**, and **what quality risks or obligations matter**.

KNOWLEDGE AREA

This guide helps with **quality expectations and measures**. Technically, it covers **quality attributes and measurable fitness**.

Guide family map

Where this guide sits in the full Blueprint Handoff Atlas family.

ROOT & CROSS-CUTTING

Handoff Atlas · Blueprint Bundle · Metamodel Vocabulary · Migrations

DESIGN

Architecture · Concepts · Domain · Dynamics · Infrastructure · Interactions · Models · **Quality** · Rules · Story

GOVERNANCE

Capability · Decisions · Motivation · Organization · Roadmap · Leverage · Test Cases · Value Stream

Capture → focus → transformation

What to gather first, what this layer focuses on, and what a modeler or AI agent can produce from it.

Capture inputs

- Measures
- Targets
- Security/compliance needs

→

Quality

This guide helps non-technical people express this layer clearly.

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Transformation outputs

- Good-enough thresholds
- Monitoring focus
- Risk visibility

Main entities in this guide

- **Metric** — a raw measurement of behavior, such as time, rate, or percentage.
- **KPI** — a business-facing target built on a metric.
- **SLO** — an internal service target the team commits to.
- **SLA** — an external promise with business consequences if it is missed.
- **Security Requirement** — a rule about protecting access, data, or auditability.
- **Compliance Requirement** — a legal, regulatory, or retention obligation.
- **Resilience Requirement** — an expectation about recovery, continuity, or failure handling.
- **Finding** — a current quality weakness or defect already observed in the system.
- **Observability** — the monitoring view made from metrics, logs, traces, and events.
    - Often confused with: **Leverage Point** in the Leverage guide. A **Finding** states what is wrong now; a leverage point states a prioritized intervention to improve it.

What belongs here

- metrics and KPIs
- service targets such as response time or uptime
- security requirements
- compliance and retention requirements
- resilience and recovery expectations
- observability expectations
- important quality findings or internal weaknesses

What does not belong here

- broad business goals without measurable or quality meaning
- the whole process flow
- static infrastructure inventory by itself

Core things to capture

- what should be measured
- what target or threshold matters
- what quality requirement must hold
- what risk or weakness already exists
- what evidence or monitoring should exist

Core relationships to capture

- goal -> KPI/metric
- operation/service -> SLO/SLA
- concept/data -> security or compliance rule
- system area -> resilience or observability need
- quality finding -> risk or remediation concern

Modus operandi

Capture quality by asking:

1. what matters to stakeholders?
2. how would we measure it?
3. what minimum acceptable target exists?
4. what obligations or protections apply?
5. what known weaknesses need visibility?

Prompt set

- what must be fast, accurate, secure, or reliable?
- how do we know whether it is good enough?
- what happens if it fails?
- what regulations or obligations apply?
- what quality problems already exist today?

Free-text intake template

- **Quality concern:**

- **Why it matters:**
- **What is measured or required:**
- **Target or threshold:**
- **Affected operations/concepts/services:**
- **Evidence/monitoring needed:**
- **Known findings or risks:**

Worked example

- Return eligibility decision should be visible to the customer within 30 seconds of submission
- Customer order data must be retained and accessed under privacy rules
- Audit logs must capture refund-decision changes

Layer-specific handoff guidance

For quality, the handoff should make **expectations testable**.

The receiver should be able to see:

- what quality concern matters
- how it is measured or observed
- what threshold or obligation exists
- what happens if it is not met

If the wording is only "important" or "better", the handoff is too vague.

How this becomes YAML

A technical modeler or AI agent can transform this into metrics, KPIs, SLOs, security, compliance, resilience, observability, and findings entries.

Common mistakes

- saying something is important without a measurable meaning
- mixing business goals with operational targets
- forgetting security/compliance obligations
- omitting known quality weaknesses because they feel uncomfortable